

Disappearing Novotny

By C.G.S.Narayanan

The disappearing Novotny (also called Romanian Novotny) is one of favourite Novotny ideas on which American composer Kabe Moen wrote a series of articles in 'The Problemist'. In this theme a piece standing at the intersection of bishop and rook lines threaten two mates. However the captures of this piece, which usually allow only one of the mates, defeat both threats and allow new mates. The problem below by the British composer is the ideal illustration of disappearing Novotny.

Colin Sydenham
I prize, BCM 1979



Mate in two moves

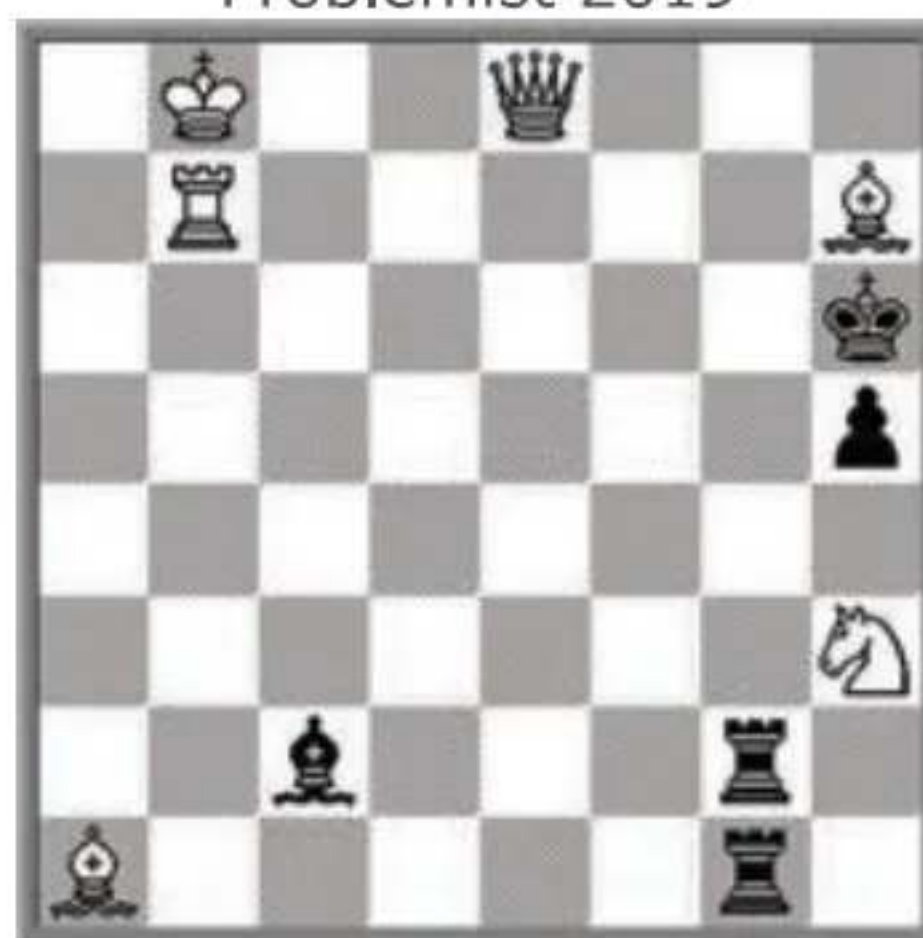
Set: 1...Kc3 2.Bd2

Key 1.Nb5! solves with standard Novotny threats 2.Qc5/Qxc4. However captures by the BR and BB do not separate the threats but lead respectively to the new mates 2.Rxc3 and 2.Bc5. The threats are indeed separated but by BPd7. The genesis of the problem was in the black/white correspondence elements. The Novotny captures are answered by the corresponding white pieces and the star defence 1...Kb5 (2.Qb6) like the key opens the line of

two corresponding pieces on to the threat squares.

In the second problem below the "disappearing" part of the Novotny, i.e., the reason that the threatened mates do not work is because of the loss of guard on h7. It may be noticed that the threats are separately forced and the mates after the captures of the key piece depend on the mutual interferences of the rook and bishop.

Kabe Moen
Problemist 2019



Mate in two moves

Key: 1.Bg6! (2.Bg7, Rh7)

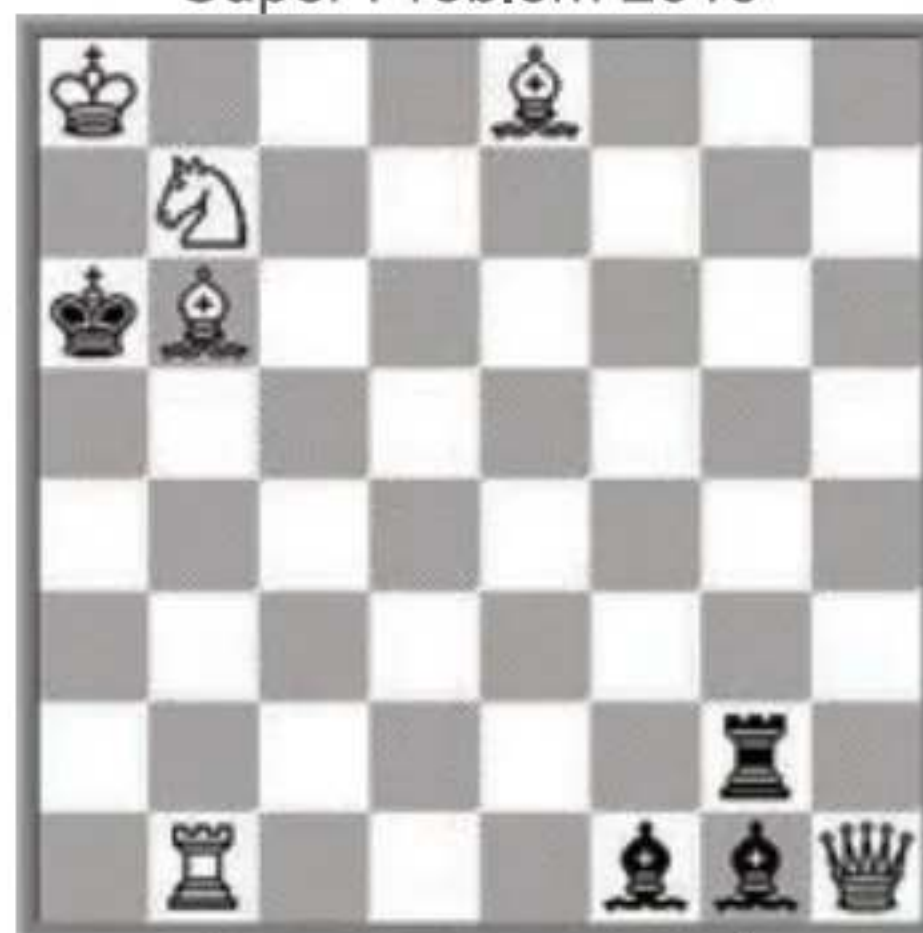
1...Bxg6 2.Qf8 (Bg7?)

1...Rxb1 2.Qh8 (Rh7?)

1...Rb1 2.Bg7; 1...Rxa1 2.Rh7

Now a 10-piece aristocrat setting of the theme for solving

Kabe Moen
Super Problem 2019



Mate in two moves

Solution to problem for solving in the article 'Salazar, a reversal theme':

Key 1.Qg2! (2.Qa2) 1...Bxd3 2.Se5
1...Bxe6 2.Qg5 mate

Readers may send in their queries to
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